

people accept as normal or even necessary.

Most who *Choose FI* opt to switch from cable TV to less expensive options or cut the cord entirely. Similarly, many on the path to FI save hundreds of dollars each month by choosing mobile virtual network operator (MVNO) plans with compatible phones they match to their individual needs rather than having the newest technology and expensive plans. A couple of examples of popular MVNO providers include Cricket Wireless utilizing the AT&T network and Google's Project Fi, which utilizes the Sprint, T-Mobile, and US Cellular networks. These decisions allow the user to spend less while living happier, healthier, and wealthier lives than those taking the standard path through life.

Stacking Benefits

Many are turned off by the idea of frugality, equating it with sacrifice. This short-term thinking will keep you trapped on the standard path. You gain traction when you leverage these powerful tools and stack the benefits. My own story is a perfect example.

After we finished college, my wife and I started down the path most people follow. We mortgaged our first house in the suburbs with only a 5 percent down payment. To avoid private mortgage insurance, we